

Speaker 1 [00:00:03] So, before we start, besides recording, I need your email to send you the consent form. You can fill it out by checking the box and there's a place for your signature. You can respond to the email with the filled-out document, typing your name in the email text, and I will sign it. Please write your full name so we have this on record. You can send it to me via [Social Media] or the chat here if the connection drops. I'll share the screen with you to make sure everything is clear. Are you able to see it?

Speaker 2 [00:01:48] Yes, but the internet is slow.

Speaker 1 [00:01:49] Mine is terrible too. So, let me read what's written here for you to be fully aware. Then we can chat a bit more. Good evening! We are conducting an exploratory study titled A Multicultural Investigation into the Conceptualization and Measurement of Relationship Quality, aiming to understand what [Ethnicity] consider to be a good relationship. We believe you can provide valuable insights, and therefore, we would like to invite you for an interview. You've already accepted the invitation, so we are here now. This will be an online interview, and we'll ask questions about your experiences and perspectives on your current romantic relationship and romantic relationships in general. If you agree to participate, the interview should last around 1 hour and is entirely voluntary. You can stop the interview at any time if you no longer wish to participate. The results will be shared with the scientific community, and the information will be anonymous and unidentifiable. If you have any questions after the interview, you can contact me at the first email, the second email is for the lab professor from [University], and the third is for the professor in the Philippines who is organizing this study. If you wish to contact him, you will need to write in English. By agreeing, the audio of this interview will be recorded as I mentioned before. You can just check the box in the form. You don't need to put an X or anything, just click to agree. About the transcription, if you agree with how the data will be shared, at the end of the interview, I will ask you again if we can use the full interview or if you want to review or remove any parts of it. At the end, I'll ask you again to make sure of this. If you agree, the data will be shared accordingly.

Speaker 2 [00:04:12] It's all good.

Speaker 1 [00:04:14] Let me stop sharing the screen. So, I'll start by asking some questions about you. Let me find my notes. Quick questions first, then we'll talk about relationships. How old are you?

Speaker 2 [00:04:38] I'm [26-30].

Speaker 1 [00:04:41] And how long have you been with your boyfriend?

Speaker 2 [00:04:46] [6-10] years.

Speaker 1 [00:04:49] Oh, a few months. He did not mentioned few months. But the important is the amount of years. And I am just joking! I think I cannot even say that.

Speaker 2: There is no problem. And usually he is who remember the months.

Speaker 1: Uau! Serious? That's great...That's great. How do you refer to him, boyfriend or something else?

Speaker 1: He is not you husband because you are not married. But, there is another term that I could use?

Speaker 2: He is my boyfriend.

Speaker 1: And do you have children?

Speaker 2 [00:05:22] No, I don't have children.

Speaker 1 [00:05:25] Who do you live with?

Speaker 2 [00:05:27] I live with my brother. Just my brother.

Speaker 1 [00:05:31] Is he older or younger?

Speaker 2 [00:05:33] He's younger, [1-5] years younger.

Speaker 1 [00:05:38] That seems like a lot, but when you're adults, it doesn't feel like much anymore.

Speaker 2 [00:05:42] Exactly.

Speaker 1 [00:05:44] As kids, it's different.

Speaker 2: Exactly!

Speaker 1: Yes. I have a brother who is [6-10] years younger and that was kind of annoying. Sometimes he calls me mother and it confuses the relationship, but now it is completely okay. Now, what's your main source of income and your current profession? You could be a [occupation].

Speaker 2 [00:06:11] I graduated, but I'm not working in my field currently. I [Job], but it's a [Company], so I'm somewhat using my training.

Speaker 1 [00:06:31] What did you study?

Speaker 2 [00:06:33] [Area of Study] and a [Degree] in [Major].

Speaker 1 [00:06:39] That sounds great. I know nothing about what you study but it sounds great. What age group do you [Job]? Children?

Speaker 2 [00:06:50] [Age group].

Speaker 1: Yes, you had mentioned. Sorry.

Speaker 1 [00:06:53] I see. Now, I want to ask you a general, philosophical question. Feel free to speak as much as you want. How did your love story begin?

Speaker 2 [00:07:14] We met in college. We started in the same year, but I didn't know him at first. He was in [Major B], and I was in [Major A] at the same college. I became friends with a mutual friend of ours who introduced us. By the second semester, we started seeing each other more often in classes and activities. He asked for my number from our mutual friend, and we started talking and hanging out.

Speaker 2: We had some classes in common and we met more frequently. So that is what happened initially.

Speaker 1: Did it take time for him to start chatting with you? Was it fast?

Speaker 2: No. It was fast. Once he got my number, he texted me, and we started to chat about our courses because that was what we have in common. We also took the same bus home. Sometimes he would join me on the way back home. We talked at college. And that's what happened. After about [11-15] days, we had our first date, and he asked me to be his girlfriend and I accepted.

Speaker 1 [00:08:08] That's great! How did he ask you?

Speaker 1: Were you expecting this? Did you want this?

Speaker 2 [00:09:00] No. We were already seeing each other, but not officially. He invited me to a restaurant, we had dinner, and then we went for a walk in a park. He said he wanted to do something crazy.

Speaker 2: I didn't imagine he was going to ask me to be her girlfriend, even though we had a lot in common, and we really agreed that it seemed like we had known each other longer because many ideas aligned and asked me to be his girlfriend. I was surprised and agreed he was crazy. I asked if he was sure about this, like three times. And he was resolute, so I said okay.

Speaker 1 [00:09:53] And now it's been [6-10] years!

Speaker 1: This is great and different because it was fast.

Speaker 2: exactly! I normally say that we are straightforward. Both of us.

Speaker 1: It's great because it puts you on another level, you cut out mind games, anxiety...

Speaker 2: Exactly! Neither he nor I have patience for this. So, we get to the point. What makes your relationship high-quality compared to others?

Speaker 2 [00:10:48] Our communication is excellent. We have mutual respect and understanding. We don't argue over trivial matters and have a deep connection.

Speaker 1: Because the others are not or the others are good but you are the worst? Not in a pejorative way.

Speaker 2: Yes. exactly because of that. We observe that in relation with some couples of friends and family, we communicate much more easily, we avoid arguing over trivial reasons, and we realize that there are some subjects that don't need to be a cause of disagreement between us. So, it's not like we are a perfect couple, we just don't fight over unnecessary things.

Speaker 1: Like immaturity..

Speaker 2: Yes! We don't argue over silly things.

Speaker 1 [00:12:15] Have you had other relationships before this one? How do they compare?

Speaker 2 [00:12:15] I had a previous relationship that was quite traumatic, which made me cautious and single for [1-5] years.

Speaker 2: I used to struggle to get involved (romantically) because I had difficulty trusting, and I had self-esteem issues. It was toxic, but it taught me a lot. Now, I know what I want and what I won't accept.

Speaker 2: Some things surprised me in this new relationship. I thought, 'Wow, is it like this? It's so easygoing? He's not demanding anything from me?' And this caused some initial discomfort. But I see that I managed to overcome it by seeing this positive side because I was able to change myself and set my boundaries. That's why I spent so much time alone. And because of that experience, I knew I could choose whether or not to get involved with someone new. This current relationship is so much better, and I value it greatly.

Speaker 1 [00:14:19] What makes a relationship high-quality for you?

Speaker 2 [00:14:38] Communication, respect even when there is intimacy, dedication, understanding and a lot of love. These are crucial for a good relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:15:37] And what about a low-quality relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:15:48] Lack of respect, understanding, and communication. Not valuing individual differences and not compromising can lead to a poor relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:16:44] How do you recognize a high or low-quality relationship when you see one?

Speaker 2 [00:17:05] Lack of respect and communication are clear indicators of a low-quality relationship. Machismo is also a big issue I notice in some relationships, and it bothers me a lot.

Speaker 1 [00:18:35] Machismo is often subtle and not easily recognized. Hearing about it from another woman helps understand these nuances.

Speaker 2 [00:18:50] Yes, it's deeply ingrained, especially in small towns. It's visible in everyday interactions and expectations of women, and normalized because it is considered the normal way to relate between men and women.

Speaker 1 [00:19:32] Where do you live?

Speaker 2 [00:19:37] I live in [City A] but am originally from [City B], a much smaller town.

Speaker 1 [00:19:43] I see. Thank you for sharing!

Speaker 2 [00:19:50] But it's due to machismo, the smaller and more entrenched the customs. And not updating, people will continue living what was passed down. And it doesn't reflect reality much.

Speaker 1 [00:20:04] Yes. Was there a moment when you felt that your relationship was disrespectful or lacked communication? Was there a time when you saw this or not? Has it always been calm?

Speaker 2 [00:20:20] But it's not a lack of respect. Because from the beginning I said to be honest, I said I like communication. If you think something you're doing is inappropriate or you don't understand it as respectful, let me know. This person doesn't have a crystal ball, there's no way to guess. So I told him, and he told me too, right? And there's always the issue of communication, what doesn't please you? What did you think, like, I didn't like this. If they say it this way, I didn't like that you said this and that. But there was a time early in the relationship, after a few months. He was joking with me as he used to joke with his friends before, out of habit. So I made a joke with him, and I said, No, this is not allowed. I'm not your friend, you have to understand that men joke a lot with each other. And then, look, it's just friendship. Exactly. You joke with your girlfriend, and it feels awkward, right? But it's common, right? Sometimes we say this guy, you don't. For God's sake, I didn't mean to accept it and it won't happen. But that time he was even surprised by my reaction, but it's something I don't tolerate. I think it's ugly, disrespectful. It's a path I don't like, because it starts with saying something like that, but then it escalates. It's something I can't stand or is disrespectful in this way. So it was something I communicated to him early on, but it was really, really, no, I don't ever want a lack of respect. No.

Speaker 1 [00:22:12] That is what is most important in a relationship. Not necessarily yours, but in general, what is most important to you?

Speaker 2 [00:22:22] Communication is communication. I really respect communication because, as I said, there's no point in being upset about something and keeping it to myself. I

need to respond and say this bothers me, because if we don't, we won't reach a consensus, there will be resentment, and he will never know because I didn't communicate it. And in the future, it could turn into a snowball and create a discussion that could have been avoided. It could be unnecessary too, because when you communicate, besides resolving a misunderstanding, there can also be interpretation errors. And that's why I say that those who communicate avoid interpretation errors from both sides, and you can see what can be changed and so on.

Speaker 1 [00:23:10] Communication makes you feel important. And now, going back to love, I wanted to know what love is to you. It doesn't have to be a definition of love.

Speaker 2 [00:23:26] Of course. To me, love is light. For a long time, I thought it was something more possessive. You have to have someone who belongs to you, but over time and understanding, I know it's something light. I understand it as something light, something mutual. It's shown in small things daily. And it is nurtured, as people say, and we understand when we are in a long-term relationship that love is nurtured by actions day by day, and it changes our lives because you have someone you trust. If you love someone, you trust them, and you will have moments in your life that you won't go through alone; you will have someone to share everything with. So love is dedication and is nurtured every day. You have to keep dedicating yourself to it.

Speaker 1 [00:24:29] Your definition is very sweet. How important is love in a relationship, considering that sometimes people might confuse love with friendship but no longer love the person? How important is love in a relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:24:49] It is always important to maintain the relationship, to have love. I don't understand how a person continues in a relationship without the feeling of love because any other feeling can't sustain it. People are transparent, and if something isn't right, if there's no more love, there's no reason to pursue it. But friendship can really be confused. But when there is love, there is the desire to continue with the person, to see that person well, and you want to see them achieve better things in life. You are happy just because the person is happy, so it's not confusing friendship; it's something more than friendship. It's a friendship that is more. That's how I see it. But there must be friendship, as there is no love without friendship. But you must love and really want to be with that person by your side and include them in everything as much as possible.

Speaker 1 [00:26:06] Without pretense. How do you know your boyfriend loves you? What does he do to show it?

Speaker 2 [00:26:16] When he likes something he does, he is very polite with me, very respectful in all his actions daily. He knows and asks how I am today, helps me when I need it, and makes himself available. That, for me, is very good. The person making themselves available to help you when you need it, listening to you, showing care, respecting you. So I know he loves me not just when he says it, but he says it often, too. He shows it daily by wanting to be with me, taking care of me, and worrying about me, so I can tell he loves me.

Speaker 1 [00:27:06] Many. Now, moving away from us, I want to think a bit about conflicts. What challenges do you face in your relationship, even if they are small compared to bigger issues?

Speaker 2 [00:27:29] In a relationship, I think the biggest challenge we face today is that we've been together for some time and have plans for the future. I graduated first, but he has been working for some time and is interning at a company. I graduated in [Year]. We have real plans for the future, but currently, we can't live together due to financial reasons. I think that is a challenge for us, in the long term, but other daily challenges, I can't think of any.

Speaker 1 [00:28:22] Like organization or any language habits that irritate you, like certain words, or values different from yours, or a relative who doesn't like him or vice versa?

Speaker 2 [00:28:43] No, no, nothing like that. Not really. My family, I think, yes, but very...

Speaker 1 [00:28:51] Annoying, isn't it? I just gave those examples to see if you had something like that.

Speaker 2 [00:28:57] I'm more organized than him. He is extremely organized, but he doesn't have a problem with my disorganization. If we were to live together, maybe it would improve, but he already knows me, and I don't think it will change. So we adapt. It's something that doesn't irritate or hinder our relationship.

Speaker 1 [00:29:33] You have to try.

Speaker 2 [00:29:34] At first, I think I am a bit scatterbrained, and that might bother him, but I don't know to what extent. Sometimes I forget dates, like a travel date, and he is very concerned about notifying because he has missed a lot in his life, although not recently, but he had some problems before, so he worries about me. He gets concerned if I don't notify him when I arrive. I am scatterbrained in this sense, so that's the only thing that generates more concern than irritation, just concern because I am a bit scatterbrained.

Speaker 1 [00:31:01] How do you resolve it if it happens that you don't notify him? Do you manage to talk and resolve it, or does it become a problem?

Speaker 2 [00:31:18] He knows it will always happen, so he already knows. There was an event when he got really upset. When there's a reason for my delay, I explain what happened, and he understands. If there's no reason, I just forgot, and he gets very upset. But I talk to him, explain, apologize, and respect his feelings until he cools down. But it's something that humor helps with because he knows how I am, and there's not much to do.

Speaker 1 [00:32:06] So, besides talking and apologizing, is there any other strategy? Or is it just communication?

Speaker 2 [00:32:27] We resolve it by talking and waiting for things to settle.

Speaker 1 [00:32:32] Differently from others?

Speaker 2 [00:32:34] Because it doesn't help to keep apologizing repeatedly. When I see he is very upset, I try to do something nice, and vice versa. He does that too. We try to please each other, like I know he loves chocolate, so I might buy him some. We have dinner together and that helps. But generally, we just talk and wait for things to settle.

Speaker 1 [00:33:05] That's nice. Do you think your relationship is good for you? Why do you think it's a good relationship?

Speaker 2 [00:33:20] It's great because I don't feel pressured or burdened by anything. I don't feel disrespected or misunderstood. It's a relationship that helps me grow and supports me a lot. My happiness and achievements are valued. He understands that I first seek stability, or better, because I like to study and aim for more. He supports me in all aspects, encouraging me to pursue my goals. For me, this represents an excellent relationship. He supports and takes good care of me, always looking out for my well-being and happiness. He listens to me and tries to understand me as much as possible, which is significant since men sometimes struggle with understanding, but he tries hard.

Speaker 1 [00:34:24] It's good to know that he tries. Another question, do you think your relationship has changed anything about you? How has it changed you?

Speaker 2 [00:34:44] In the new world where everyone comments, after a certain time in the relationship, I noticed, and others around me commented too, that I became a much calmer and more loving person. I started to express myself better with others too. I used to be more impatient and irritable, but after this relationship, I managed to show more affection to people around me.

Speaker 1 [00:35:20] To everyone?

Speaker 2 [00:35:22] Yes, to everyone. I became this more loving person who hugs and says I like and love people. I couldn't imagine being affectionate or clingy, hugging someone in public. I didn't see myself that way. After this relationship, I am this more attentive person.

Speaker 1 [00:35:54] Great! Do you think your boyfriend has changed during the relationship? How?

Speaker 2 [00:36:00] I think so. When we started dating, he was a bit more immature. I always had a more mature circle of friends and understood things better. Sometimes I felt a bit of immaturity in him early on, but over time, I saw him mature in many aspects of his life. So, I think it has been positive for him too.

Speaker 1 [00:38:16] It's great to know. Do you feel secure in your relationship? What makes you feel secure?



Speaker 2 [00:38:30] Yes, I feel very secure with him. He makes me feel secure not just through words but actions. I feel that we have always had a connection, and it feels like we've known each other longer than we have. We think similarly, and I trust him completely. If there was something wrong, I would know because of how well I know him. He has never done anything to make me feel insecure.

Speaker 1 [00:39:23] You can express yourself freely with him?

Speaker 2 [00:39:29] Yes, I can cry in front of him and express my feelings. He has never done anything to inhibit my feelings or make me feel insecure.

Speaker 1 [00:39:41] That's good to know. Moving on, I will present the first statement, "My partner really listens to me" which should be answered on a scale from 1 to 9. You will choose the number that makes the most sense for the statement.

Speaker 2 [00:40:50] Nine is not the only meaning.

Speaker 1 [00:40:53] Great. So, the next jewel of the scale. And the next statement as well. If your boyfriend cares about your needs. There wasn't. So, why did you mark nine and not eight? Because it's 100%.

Speaker 2 [00:41:18] Because they 100% always show it, they always want to know about me, help me with everything, and he always asks me what I need, he helps me, so it's 100%.

Speaker 1 [00:41:32] I'll keep the screen up because we'll need it later, but if it's bothering you. Don't stop now.

Speaker 2 [00:41:40] No, it's okay.

Speaker 1 [00:41:43] Okay? So the next question is only if you feel comfortable talking about it, otherwise we can skip it. I wanted to know if you have been having sexual relations frequently, lately, and recently.

Speaker 2 [00:42:01] The more we have, the better.

Speaker 2 [00:42:05]: Again, not as much as we would like, but when we can.

Speaker 1 [00:42:10]: Time constraints like siblings as well.

Speaker 2 [00:42:12]: I thought there were issues between us, but it's just timing. When it works out, it feels right.

Speaker 1 [00:42:21]: I understand. And are you satisfied with your sex life? And why do you think it's not 100%?

Speaker 2 [00:42:30]: 90%, not 100%, because we can't be more present in that sense. But it's because of life circumstances. But if it weren't for that, it wouldn't matter compared to how fulfilled I feel otherwise.

Speaker 1 [00:42:48]: Okay, so the next question also uses a scale, but not a numerical one. How satisfied are you with your relationship overall? Love, communication, difficulties, sex life, and in general?

Speaker 2 [00:43:09]: Completely satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:43:12]: Completely satisfied.

Speaker 2 [00:43:13]: Yes, completely.

Speaker 1 [00:43:17]: Why are you completely satisfied even with financial issues and not living together yet? Why is it still important?

Speaker 2 [00:43:29]: Because, as I said, I know what an unhealthy relationship looks like. And I know that with him, I am very happy and fulfilled. I know it's healthy and good. He is essentially good for me, and we are good together. So, I am 100% satisfied, completely satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:43:53]: I understand. And the last scale question, still about this topic, how do you rate your satisfaction? You said completely satisfied, but in numbers, what number would you choose?

Speaker 2 [00:44:12]: In this case, I'd pick 9, completely satisfied.

Speaker 1 [00:44:14]: Not to complete the table, just the number that seems right to you. That was the last question. And I just wanted to thank you for your participation, because I know it's a long interview and a very intimate subject. But I really appreciate it because it was very difficult to get someone to agree to this interview. Thank you so much for your time and willingness to talk about these things. I loved the interview, it was very interesting, and you two really seem very compatible, very good answers. All the answers matched very well and.

Speaker 2 [00:44:53]: I can't even talk about the relationship without wanting to talk about him, which is great in that sense because he is very good.

Speaker 1 [00:45:05]: It's not easy to find someone who is 100% aligned, you can't take that for granted.

Speaker 2 [00:45:11]: We really do complete each other. I tell him that we complete each other in what we don't complete, we complement because we think very similarly. They are very practical, as I said, I see that as a positive point because we don't dwell on unnecessary things. Everything is as smooth as a well-oiled machine. We are very close, very compatible, and we love each other very much. I think in our daily lives, everything we do shows our care for each other and it translates well. So, I am grateful. I loved participating.

Speaker 1 [00:45:51]: That's really great.

Speaker 2 [00:45:52]: Yes, I really enjoyed participating and collaborating. When I mentioned it to him, he agreed right away.

Speaker 1 [00:46:00]: Thank you so much! Just remember to respond to the term, and I'll send you another email tonight, but you can reply whenever you want, with a link to a form for the research from [Name] in the Philippines, which is just to evaluate the interviews in general. Also, if you know of any other couples who might be interested in doing this type of interview, please let me know because I need to do five. I only have one so far. If you have any contacts, please send them my way. Thank you so much! I remember mentioning to him at the end of the interview that many people say you look like siblings. I have a theory, not scientifically backed, but whenever I see a couple that looks physically alike, they always seem to be a good match. Super compatible, super friendly. So, I loved that he said that because it's something that many people also notice.

Speaker 2 [00:47:00]: Many people think we look alike physically.

Speaker 1 [00:47:04]: When we go out with my mom.

Speaker 2 [00:47:06]: Yes, with my mom and my brother, one time we went out the four of us, and people thought we were all my mom's children. People really get confused.

Speaker 1 [00:47:22]: Yes, that's really cool. Congratulations on your relationship, it's very rare to see something like that, so congratulations, and thank you very much.

Speaker 2 [00:47:32]: Thank you for letting me participate, I'm happy to help. If I find another couple I'll let you know.

Speaker 1 [00:47:37]: Thank you very much, goodbye. Good night!

Speaker 2 [00:47:39]: Good night.